PassFrame
TUITION

Journey to the Top of the World

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Non-fiction (Geography)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Mount Everest stands at 8,849 metres above sea level, making it the tallest mountain on Earth. Towering over the border between Nepal and Tibet, its peak is so high that the air there contains barely a third of the oxygen found at sea level.

For centuries, Everest was considered impossible to climb. Many expeditions attempted to reach the summit throughout the early twentieth century, but each one failed, often at great cost — several climbers lost their lives in the attempt.

That changed on 29th May 1953, when Edmund Hillary, a beekeeper from New Zealand, and Tenzing Norgay, a Sherpa mountaineer from Nepal, became the first people ever confirmed to reach the summit. The two men worked as a team throughout their final, gruelling climb, each relying completely on the other's skill and determination.

Conditions near the top of Everest are brutal. Temperatures can plunge far below freezing, winds howl at hurricane speed, and the lack of oxygen makes even simple movements exhausting. Climbers today often carry oxygen tanks to help them survive this extreme environment, known among mountaineers as the “death zone.”

Since Hillary and Tenzing's historic climb, thousands of people have successfully reached the summit of Everest. Yet the mountain remains one of the most dangerous places on Earth, and every attempt still demands enormous courage, skill and preparation.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. How tall is Mount Everest, according to the text?

2. Between which two countries does Everest's peak lie?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you early attempts to climb Everest often failed.

4. Underline the sentence that names the two men who first reached the summit.

5. What does “gruelling” suggest about the final part of Hillary and Tenzing's climb?

6. True or false: climbers today never need extra oxygen to reach the summit.

7. Why do you think the area near the top of Everest is nicknamed the “death zone”?

8. What job did Edmund Hillary have before his famous climb?

9. In your own words, explain why reaching the top of Everest was considered impossible for so long.

10. What does the final sentence suggest about how dangerous Everest still is today?

11. Why do you think the author included the exact date of Hillary and Tenzing's successful climb?

12. Do you think you would want to attempt to climb Everest? Explain your answer using evidence from the text.